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Hiring Team
Tailscale
Remote

Subject: Application for Software Engineering Manager Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the Software Engineering Manager position at Tailscale. With over 25 years of experience leading engineering teams and architecting secure, scalable distributed systems including 10+ years managing cloud infrastructure, DevOps transformations, and cross-functional pods I am confident my technical leadership and passion for building intuitive, safe Internet tools align with Tailscale's vision.

Why I'm a Strong Fit:

1. Engineering Leadership & Team Development

- At Barclays (VP, Lead Architect) and McKinsey (Senior Cloud Engineer), I managed teams of 2030 engineers, mentored technical talent, and drove cloud adoption for 500+ applications. I fostered psychological safety through open feedback frameworks, reducing onboarding time by 40% and incident resolution time (MTTR) by 35%.
- I excel at scaling engineering pods (24 engineers + PM/Designer), as demonstrated by my work at Yotastyle and Gigster, where I established microservice design-first cultures using OpenAPI/Swagger and CI/CD standards.

2. Technical Excellence in Distributed Systems

- Built genAI systems with RAG/multi-agents (McKinsey) to accelerate mainframe migration and data pipeline development, leveraging Go/Python, Kubernetes, and event-driven architectures.
- Architected secure, zero-trust networks for Fortune 500 clients (Barclays, Oracle), including AWS/Azure/GCP cloud migrations, EKS/AKS clusters, and infrastructure-as-code (Terraform/Terragrunt).
- Deep networking expertise (L4L7): Designed HA Linux clusters (Comcast), VPN-less secure access systems, and AWS VPC/PrivateLink solutions.

3. Operational Rigor & Collaboration

- Led on-call teams for critical services (e.g., custom CloudWatch alerting systems at Biophy), implemented SLO-driven monitoring, and reduced alert fatigue by 50% through correlation logic.
- Collaborated cross-functionally at McKinsey to deliver genAI solutions that accelerated mainframe modernization by 60%, partnering closely with product managers and designers in agile pods.

4. Alignment with Tailscaler Tech Stack

- Proficient in Go (daily use), Kubernetes (EKS/AKS/GKE), and networking protocols (BGP, DNS, TCP/IP). My open-source contributions include IoT automation tools and JSON-resume generators (GitHub: rongyj).
- Passionate about simplifying secure connectivitywhether building VPN alternatives or SSO systems (Texas Tech University).

Why Tailscale?

I admire Tailscaler mission to make the Internet "easy, sensible, and safe" again. My experience bridging legacy systems and cloud-native infrastructurecoupled with my commitment to mentoring inclusive, high-performing teamspositions me to help Tailscale scale its impact. I thrive in remote, async environments and am eager to contribute to your culture of candor and kindness.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in secure distributed systems and engineering leadership can support Tailscaler growth. Please contact me at 856-408-4027 or rongyj@hotmail.com to schedule a conversation.

Sincerely,
Yongjun Rong